

» FOSSIL INVERTEBRATES



ARTICULATE BRACHIOPOD
Leptaena rhomboidalis

A brachiopod from Ordovician, Silurian, and Devonian strata, *Leptaena* grew to about 5 cm (2 in) in width. Its shell had concentric and radial ribs.



RHYNCHONELLID BRACHIOPOD
Homeorhynchia acuta

Found in Early Jurassic strata, *Homeorhynchia* was a small brachiopod that grew to about 1 cm (3/8 in) in width.

SPIRIFERID BRACHIOPOD

Spiriferina walcotti

A common brachiopod from Triassic and Jurassic strata, *Spiriferina* had a rounded shell up to 3 cm (1 1/4 in) wide, with clearly visible growth lines.

growth line

**SWAMP CLAM**

Carbonicola pseudorobusta
Occurring in non-marine rocks of the Carboniferous Period, *Carbonicola* had a tapered shell. Its fossils have been used in the relative dating of these rocks.



ribbed valve

SCALLOP

Pecten maximus

Found in Paleogene to recent rocks, *Pecten* is a genus of bivalve molluscs. *P. maximus* is extant and swims by flapping its valves.

**CLAM**

Crassatella lamellosa

A small bivalve from Cretaceous to Miocene times, *Crassatella* had marked concentric growth lines on its shell.

**MUSSEL RELATIVE**

Ambonychia sp.

Found in Ordovician strata, *Ambonychia*, an early bivalve mollusc, grew up to 6 cm (2 1/2 in) wide. Both valves had radial ribs on the surface.

DEVIL'S TOENAIL

Gryphaea arcuata

This fossil oyster occurs in Triassic and Jurassic rocks. *Gryphaea* had one large, hooked valve and a smaller, flat one.

**DEVONIAN GASTROPOD**

Murchisonia bilineata

A gastropod mollusc from Silurian to Permian strata, *Murchisonia* grew up to 5 cm (2 in) tall, with ridges around its whorls.



whorl with ridges

**JURASSIC GASTROPOD**

Pleurotomaria anglica

Found in Jurassic and Cretaceous rocks, this gastropod mollusc had a broad shell with a combination of radial and spiral patterns.

**ROSTROCONCH**

Conocardium sp.

Occurring in Devonian and Carboniferous strata, *Conocardium* resembled clams, but its shell had no functional hinge.

**NAUTILOID**

Vestinautilus cariniferus

This early *Nautilus* relative had very open coiling and little shell ornamentation. *Vestinautilus* is found in Carboniferous rocks.

**DEVONIAN AMMONOID**

Soliclymenia paradoxa

An Early Devonian ammonoid, *Soliclymenia* had thin ribs across the shell. Some species had an unusual, triangular shell.

CARBONIFEROUS AMMONOID

Goniatites crenistria

An ammonoid mollusc from Devonian and Carboniferous rocks, *Goniatites* had angular sutures where the chamber walls joined the shell.

**TRIASSIC AMMONOID**

Ceratites nodosus

Found in Triassic strata, *Ceratites* was an ammonoid mollusc. Its heavily ornamented shell had open coiling and strong ribs.



simple rib

AMMONITE

Mortoniceras rostratum

This ammonite mollusc from the Cretaceous Period grew up to 10 cm (4 in) in diameter, with ribs across the shell.



shell aperture